

Alvaro Mercado

SENIOR SOFTWARE ENGINEER · ARCHITECTURE · CLOUD & INFRASTRUCTURE

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SUMMARY

Senior software engineer with **14 years** designing, building and optimizing production systems — much of it as an **independent contractor for international clients via Upwork (5.0★ rating, 10,000+ billed hours across 10 projects)**, and currently at **ITTI**, one of Paraguay's leading fintech companies. Specialized in **system design** and **resource optimization**, with a growing focus on Cloud/DevOps across GCP, AWS and Kubernetes. Experienced with electronic invoicing (SIFEN) and payment gateways, and workflow automation with AI agents (MCP). Native Spanish, advanced English.

EXPERIENCE

ITTI — Fintech/Regtech · e-invoicing, payments & core banking

2024 — Present · 2 yrs

SOFTWARE ENGINEER

Development and maintenance of **BIMS**, a system serving **1,000+ clients nationwide**, including integration with **SIFEN** (Paraguay's national e-invoicing system), within one of the country's leading fintech/regtech companies (ISO 27001/9001 certified). Bugfixing and code/infrastructure optimization (Redis caching, SQS queues), deployments on **AWS and GCP**, and redesign of delivery processes to speed up client delivery. **Automation of management workflows through AI agents with MCP integrations**. Security hardening and performance monitoring, in cross-functional teams of 20+ engineers.

CakePHP PHP SIFEN Redis SQS AWS GCP Kubernetes Docker PostgreSQL AI Agents MCP
Security Monitoring

eLeap LMS

2020 — 2024 · 4 yrs

FULL-STACK DEVELOPER · FREELANCE (UPWORK)

Design and implementation of features for a large-scale LMS. Code improvements, building and maintaining REST API endpoints, **database optimization** and AWS service integration over Docker-based deployment pipelines with Percona DB.

Laravel AWS JavaScript Docker PerconaDB Bootstrap CSS Core PHP Amplitude

TowerHouseStudio

2020 — 2021 · 1 yr

BACK-END DEVELOPER · FREELANCE (UPWORK)

Building and maintaining web system features with Laravel 8 and AWS (SQS queues). CronJob implementation, Scrum methodology and Docker-based infrastructure.

Laravel AWS SQS Docker CronJobs Scrum

ChatterSource

2020 · 6 mos

FULL-STACK DEVELOPER · FREELANCE (UPWORK)

CMS with full API and UI, JWT authentication and role-based access control with Laravel, Vue.js and Tailwind CSS.

Laravel Vue.js MySQL Docker Tailwind CSS Git

Petcheck Technology

2017 – 2020 · 3 yrs

FULL-STACK DEVELOPER & TESTER · FREELANCE (UPWORK)

API implementation and documentation with Laravel. Platform maintenance with CodeIgniter and React.js. Built a full automated test suite with Selenium in JavaScript.

Laravel · Node.js · React.js · Selenium · MySQL · CodeIgniter · Bootstrap CSS

Borealis Consulting

2015 – 2016 · 1 yr

FULL-STACK DEVELOPER · CONTRACTOR

Full-stack development with CodeIgniter, Laravel and Ruby on Rails. UI design and database management with MySQL and PostgreSQL.

Laravel · CodeIgniter · Ruby on Rails · MySQL · PostgreSQL

Amedia Creative Inc

2012 – 2014 · 2 yrs

JR. DEVELOPER · CONTRACTOR

Backend and frontend development with the Zend PHP framework, HTML, CSS, JavaScript and MySQL.

PHP · Zend · JavaScript · MySQL · HTML/CSS

SKILLS

ARCHITECTURE & CLOUD/DEVOPS

System design · Resource optimization · GCP · AWS · Kubernetes · Docker · Linux · Bash · CI/CD · SQS · Hardening & Monitoring

FRONTEND

React.js · Vue.js · Nuxt.js · JavaScript · Tailwind CSS · Bootstrap

DOMAIN & PRODUCTIVITY

SIFEN / E-invoicing · Payment gateways · AI-assisted development · Agentic automation (MCP)

BACKEND

PHP · Laravel · CakePHP · CodeIgniter · Zend · Node.js · TypeScript · REST API

DATABASES

PostgreSQL · MySQL · PerconaDB · MongoDB · Redis

TESTING & TOOLS

Selenium · Unit testing · Load testing · Git · Scrum

EDUCATION

Software Engineering

Universidad Nacional de Itapúa 2010 – 2021

Linux Systems Administration

Universidad Nacional de Itapúa 2012

Associate Cloud Engineer (GCP) — in progress

Google Cloud

LANGUAGES

Spanish — Native English — Advanced